GUIDELINES ON ALTERATION & ADDITION (A&A) WORKS FOR COMMERCIAL TENANTS

Edition 2025 (issued 3 February 2025). These guidelines explain what approvals tenants of HEB commercial premises need before carrying out renovation or alteration and addition (A&A) works, and the conditions that apply.

1. Why Approval is Required

HEB commercial premises are mostly at the ground floor of residential blocks. Works that affect structural elements, building services, fire safety provisions or the external facade can affect residents' safety and the building's integrity. All A&A works therefore need HEB's written approval before they start, except for the minor works listed in section 3.

2. Categories of Works

Category	Examples	Approval	Processing time
Exempt (minor)	Painting, loose furniture, shelving not fixed to walls, replacing light fittings	Not required; notify Estate Manager	-
Category A (non-structural)	Partition walls (drywall), false ceilings, signage, shopfront glazing, electrical rewiring within unit	Required	10 working days
Category B (services)	Plumbing, grease traps, exhaust ducting, air-conditioning condensers, gas piping	Required; licensed contractors	14 working days
Category C (structural)	Hacking of walls, new openings, mezzanine floors, floor screed > 50 mm, roof works	Required; PE endorsement	21 working days

3. Exempt Works

Exempt works must not damage the structure, obstruct fire safety equipment or change the external appearance. Tenants must still tell the Estate Manager at least 3 working days beforehand, so that complaints from residents can be handled.

4. Documents Required

Code	Document	Category A	Category B	Category C
AA	Application for A&A works (form PLG-AA-01)	Yes	Yes	Yes
DWG	Layout and elevation drawings (scale 1:50 or 1:100)	Yes	Yes	Yes
CON	Contractor's registration certificate	Yes	Yes	Yes
PE	Professional Engineer endorsement	-	If structural support	Yes
MS	Method statement and work schedule	Yes	Yes	Yes
INS	Contractor's all-risk insurance certificate	Yes	Yes	Yes

5. Conditions of Approval

1. Works may only be done between 9.00 am and 6.00 pm on Mondays to Saturdays. Noisy works (hacking, drilling) are limited to 10.00 am - 5.00 pm.
2. No works on Sundays or public holidays.
3. Debris must be bagged and removed daily, not left in common areas.
4. Hoarding must be put up for works lasting more than 3 days.
5. Fire safety provisions must stay operational at all times.
6. The tenant must reinstate the premises at the end of the tenancy unless HEB agrees in writing otherwise.

7 Any damage to common property will be repaired at the tenant's cost.

6. Fees

Item	Fee (before GST)
Category A processing fee	S$150
Category B processing fee	S$250
Category C processing fee	S$500
Re-submission after rejection	50% of processing fee
Inspection of completed works (Category C)	S$200

7. Prohibited Works

- Removal or weakening of columns, beams or load-bearing walls.
- Installation of cooking facilities in units not approved for F&B.
- Enclosure of common corridors or five-foot ways.
- Installation of gas cylinders above 2 x 50 kg in eating houses without CDA approval.
- Changes to the external facade colour scheme of the block.

8. Unapproved Works

If works are carried out without approval, HEB may order them to stop, require the premises to be reinstated within 30 days, and impose composition fees under PLG-POL-001 clause 8. Repeated breaches may lead to termination being considered.

9. Completion

The tenant must submit completion photos within 7 days of completing Category A and B works. Category C works need a completion inspection and a PE certificate of supervision.

Annex 1 - Drawing Requirements

Item	Requirement
Title block	Unit address, unit ID, tenant name, drawing number, revision, date, scale
Layout plan	Existing and proposed layouts shown separately; new works hatched
Elevations	Shopfront elevation with signage dimensions; display area line at 0.6 m (void deck) or 1.0 m (NC, pilot)
Services	Electrical single-line diagram for rewiring; plumbing layout for wet works
Fire safety	Exits, extinguishers, hose reels marked; travel distances

Annex 2 - Sample Method Statement Headings

1. Scope of works
2. Sequence and schedule
3. Manpower and supervision
4. Plant and equipment
5. Noise and dust control
6. Debris management
7. Safety measures and permits
8. Emergency contacts

Annex 3 - Frequently Asked Questions

Question	Answer
Do I need approval to change my signboard?	Yes, Category A. Signboard must not exceed the shopfront width or 600 mm in height.
Can I install an air-con condenser on the external wall?	Only at designated condenser ledges (Category B).
Can I knock down the wall between two units I rent?	Category C with PE endorsement; both tenancies must be in the same name.
How long is the approval valid?	Works must start within 3 months of approval and complete within 6 months.

Annex 4 - Trade-specific Requirements

Trade	Additional requirements	Typical category
Coffeeshop / eating house	Grease interceptor sized per EHA guidelines; exhaust duct with access panels every 3 m; quarterly duct cleaning record; gas installation by licensed gas worker; CDA fire safety certificate for ORA enclosures	B / C
Bakery & confectionery	Oven exhaust and heat shielding; floor trap with grease basket; ovens above 20 kW need electrical load approval	B
Clinics (GP, dental, TCM)	Radiation shielding plan for X-ray rooms (dental); clinical waste store; wash-hand basins in each consultation room	A / B
Childcare / tuition	Child-safe glazing; additional exit if occupant load exceeds 50; no mezzanine	A / C
Minimart / provision	Chiller condensers only at designated ledges; floor loading check for racking above 2.4 m	A / B
Hair salon	Additional water points and floor traps; hair traps on all basins	B
Bubble tea / snack kiosk	Sink with hot and cold water; no cooking with open flame in kiosks	A / B

Annex 5 - Worked Examples

Example 1: Shopfront and signage replacement (Category A)

A florist wants to replace its aluminium shopfront with frameless glass and install a new lightbox sign. Documents: AA, DWG (elevation showing sign dimensions), CON, MS, INS. No PE endorsement is needed. Processing time: 10 working days. Fee: S$150.

Example 2: Grease trap and exhaust ducting for a new restaurant (Category B)

A unit approved for change of trade to restaurant needs a grease interceptor and an exhaust duct to the roof. Documents: AA, DWG (plumbing layout and duct route), CON (licensed plumber and M&E contractor), MS, INS. The duct route through common areas needs Town Council consent. Processing time: 14 working days. Fee: S$250.

Example 3: Combining two adjoining units (Category C)

A tuition centre renting #02-05 and #02-06 wants to open the party wall. Documents: all of the above plus PE endorsement with structural calculations and a lintel detail. Both tenancies must be in the same name and expire on the same date. Processing time: 21 working days. Fees: S$500 processing plus S$200 completion inspection. On termination, the wall must be reinstated unless HEB agrees otherwise.

Example 4: Works started without approval

During a routine inspection, a minimart is found to have installed a mezzanine for storage. It is a Category C structural work done without approval. The Estate Manager issues a stop-work order. The tenant must remove the mezzanine within 30 days and pay a composition fee of S$500 (POL-001 cl. 8). If the tenant wants to keep it, they must submit a retrospective application with PE certification of the as-built structure. Approval is not guaranteed.

Annex 6 - Approval Process Flow

1. Tenant submits form PLG-AA-01 with documents to the Estate Manager (email or HEB branch).
2. Leasing Officer checks completeness against the ALTERATION checklist within 3 working days; issues TPL-DOC-02 if anything is missing.
3. Estate Manager assesses impact on structure, services, fire safety and neighbours; consults Civil & Structural for Category C.
4. Approval letter issued with conditions, or rejection with reasons.
5. Tenant notifies start date at least 3 working days in advance; Estate Manager may inspect during works.
6. Tenant submits completion photos or, for Category C, the PE certificate of supervision; Estate Manager closes the case.

Annex 7 - Reinstatement Standards

Element	Standard on handover
Walls	Original layout restored; patched and painted in HEB standard white
Floor	Original tiles or equivalent; no screed above original level
Ceiling	False ceilings removed unless HEB agrees in writing to keep them
Services	Tenant-installed services capped off safely; DB board labelled
Shopfront	Original roller shutter in working condition
Signage	All signage removed; wall made good

Annex 8 - Contacts

Matter	Contact
A&A applications (East)	Marcus Lim, Estate Manager (East)
A&A applications (West)	Benjamin Ho, Estate Manager (West)
Completeness checks	Siti Aishah Yusof, Leasing Officer
Policy questions	Rajesh Pillai, Deputy Director